

Attachment 10

Data Management Plan

To Renounce Liberty? A Public-Goods Experiment on (Un)Democratic Reversal

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1. Data and documentation

The project will create a structured oTree dataset for 300 completed adult participants in approximately 28–30 matching pools of 10 or 15. The research data include participant, session, and laboratory-site codes; pool size and temporary-group identifiers; randomized recovery or persistence assignment; institutional ballots; uniformly randomized leader selection; proposed allocations and transfers; approval decisions; fallback allocations; payoffs; response times and delay flags; practice and comprehension responses; unpaid expectations; and the final questionnaire. Eleven process items concern the experimental situation and institutions. Twelve optional background items record age group, gender, education, household financial strain, 2023 parliamentary vote, left–right placement, democratic support and satisfaction, strong-leader views, political efficacy, generalized trust, and risk willingness. Party vote and political-attitude responses are special-category personal data.

The experimental interface does not require names, contact details, national identification numbers, audio, video, location tracking, or free-text responses. Background questions are optional and use prespecified categories or scales. Limited technical logs may be generated for security and troubleshooting. Recruitment, scheduling, attendance, and payment records in UTU Choice Lab’s UTU RPP/TOKA system or DMLab’s ORSEE system are host-laboratory operational records held separately from the experimental dataset.

Data will be exported in open, non-proprietary or widely supported formats such as CSV, with analysis code and documentation in text-based formats. A data dictionary, variable labels, treatment-assignment record, session log, code version, and processing history will document provenance and allow the analysis to be reproduced.

2. Collection, quality, and version control

oTree records entries directly from participant screens. The software prevents participants from entering values outside the permitted limits. Guided practice and five comprehension questions precede paid rounds. The system records response times but does not create random answers or automatically advance strategic decisions. Laboratory staff document technical interruptions and manual prompts in a session log.

Before production, technical and behavioral pilots will test both treatment branches, synchronized waits, 10- and 15-person pools, mixed-pool sessions, rematching, refresh recovery, exports, and payment calculations. Production code and the analysis plan will be versioned and frozen after pilot revisions. Data collection is planned for 1–31 October 2026. Raw exports will be preserved read-only; cleaning will occur through scripted transformations that create derived files rather than overwriting raw data.

3. Legal and ethical basis

Registration through the host laboratory’s participant system records acceptance of that laboratory’s general rules and privacy information. oTree separately records a concise, study-specific ethical consent before experimental decisions. Personal-data processing is necessary for scientific research carried out in the public interest under GDPR Article 6(1)(e) and the Finnish Data Protection Act (1050/2018), section 4(3); consent to participate is not used as the GDPR processing basis. Because questionnaire responses may reveal political opinions, the project also applies GDPR Article 9(2)(j) and section 6(1)(7) of the Finnish Data Protection Act, with Article 89 safeguards. Data minimisation, pseudonymisation, access restriction, separation of operational identifiers, and de-identified reporting are applied throughout.

4. Storage, security, and access

Production data will be collected through oTree hosted on a University of Turku IT server with an utu.fi domain in Finland, including when a session is held at DMLab. Coded research data and backups will remain on storage provided or approved by University IT. The public prototype will not collect live research data. No personal data are transferred outside the EU or EEA.

During the project, research data will be stored on University IT-provided servers protected by institutional

credentials, role-based access, encrypted connections, managed backups, and two-factor authentication where available. Local working copies will be limited to encrypted University-managed devices and removed when no longer needed. Email and portable unencrypted media will not be used to transfer research data.

Access to coded research data will be limited to Janne Tukiainen, Hector Bahamonde, and authorised personnel who need it for collection, quality control, analysis, or data management. The host laboratory retains identifying recruitment, scheduling, attendance, and payment information but does not receive the research analysis dataset. Researchers receive only coded experimental data. When DMLab is used, Tampere University separately controls its participant-registry records under its own privacy notice; this does not transfer control of the University of Turku research dataset. External collaborators will receive only anonymised data unless controller roles, access needs, and data-protection agreements are documented in advance.

5. Pseudonymisation and participant rights

The host laboratory assigns the code used to enter the laboratory session and keeps any temporary identity-to-code link separate from research responses. The research team does not receive this link. The host laboratory removes it once compensation has been paid under its procedure. The oTree export records the study-specific consent response, form version, timestamp, and laboratory site. Pool size and group identifiers remain because they are required for randomization and analysis, but they will not be published in a form that permits re-identification through small cells.

Participants are informed through a participant information sheet and privacy notice. Before payment, applicable requests concerning the experimental record are directed to Janne Tukiainen and handled with the host laboratory and, where appropriate, the University of Turku Data Protection Officer. Requests concerning a host laboratory's separate participant register follow that laboratory's privacy notice. After the host laboratory removes the link, the research team cannot locate an individual's coded record, consistent with GDPR Article 11.

6. Retention, sharing, and disposal

Coded research data without direct identifiers will be retained on University IT-provided storage for analysis, verification, and compatible future scientific research. The host laboratory removes any identity-to-code link after payment under its procedure. The retention need will be reviewed five years after publication of the primary results and at regular intervals thereafter; data no longer necessary for an approved scientific purpose will be securely deleted or irreversibly anonymised. Anonymised data, metadata, analysis code, and non-identifying experimental materials may be preserved for reproducibility and future scientific use.

The project follows the University of Turku principle that research outputs should be as open as possible and as closed as necessary. A disclosure-risk review will precede any release. Public replication files will exclude participant labels, session dates or other indirect identifiers that create re-identification risk, rare small-cell combinations, and any variables that cannot be shared lawfully. Where a useful dataset cannot be fully anonymised, metadata and code may be public while data access remains restricted or is not offered.

7. Responsibilities, incidents, and resources

Janne Tukiainen, as Principal Investigator, is responsible for project oversight and serves as the project contact. Hector Bahamonde supports the implementation and updating of this plan, data documentation, and coordination with the host laboratories, University data support, and the Data Protection Officer. Authorised team members are responsible for confidentiality and secure handling. Suspected loss, unauthorised access, or disclosure will be reported promptly through University incident procedures, access will be contained, and notification duties will be assessed with the relevant controller and Data Protection Officer.

Data-management costs are modest and include secure institutional storage, staff time for documentation and disclosure review, and any approved repository or controlled-access service. The plan will be reviewed after pilots, before production, and whenever the platform, collaborators, collected variables, or sharing plan changes materially. Any substantive questionnaire addition, replacement, or new construct will be used only after the applicable ethics amendment or addendum and corresponding privacy-document update. The final DMP may also be recorded in DMPTuuli, as recommended by the University of Turku.